

A short reflection on today's Gospel Matthew 16:13-20

In today's Gospel, Jesus asks his disciples a question that goes to the heart of our faith: "Who do you say that I am?" Peter answers with courage and conviction: "You are the Christ, the Son of the living God."

It is a question Jesus asks each one of us too. We may know about Jesus through Scripture, prayer and the life of the Church, but Jesus invites us to something deeper than simply knowing about him. He asks us to recognise him personally as the Son of God and to place our lives in his hands.

Peter's answer is a moment of great faith, yet Jesus also reminds him that this faith is a gift from God. The Church itself is built upon this faith, and Christ promises that the powers of evil will not overcome it. These words are a source of hope for us, especially when our own faith feels weak or when the Church faces difficulties.

Our response to Jesus cannot remain only words. To call him "the Christ" means allowing his presence to shape the way we live: how we treat others, how readily we forgive, how we respond to those in need, and how faithfully we carry our own crosses.

Perhaps then, this Gospel invites us to pause and answer Jesus' question for ourselves: Who is Jesus for me? May we have the grace to recognise him more clearly, trust him more deeply, and follow him more faithfully each day.

Prayer for Vocations to the Priesthood: In this Sunday's gospel Peter acknowledges Jesus as the Christ, the Son of the living God, and Jesus confers on Peter "...the keys of the Kingdom..." an image reflected in the First Reading where the Lord says He will "...place the key of David..." on the shoulder of those called to lead His people, those who will be called "father."

Today, Sunday 23rd August, we celebrate with joy the Solemnity of our patron, Saint Eugene, whose name and witness have a special place in the life of Saint Eugene's Cathedral. Saint Eugene served the Church with courage and faith, remaining faithful to Christ in challenging times. His life reminds us that holiness is not simply about great deeds, but about faithfully following Christ in the circumstances in which God has placed us.

As we celebrate our patronal feast, we give thanks for the faith handed down to us and for the living community that gathers in this Cathedral. Saint Eugene's witness encourages us to remain steadfast in our faith, generous in our service of others, and united as a parish family.

May Saint Eugene pray for our Cathedral community and for all who enter through its doors. May his example inspire us to proclaim Christ with courage and to live our faith with joy.

St Eugene, pray for us.

Save the Date: Saint Carlo Acutis Day of Prayer. You are invited to come to St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry on Sunday 11th October from 2.00pm where we will have Veneration of a First Class Relic of St Carlo Acutis, gifted to the Cathedral by Carlo's mother, Antonia. The Sacrament of Confession will be available from 2.00pm until Mass at 7.00pm, which will be celebrated by Bishop Michael Router. Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament will take place in the Mother Teresa Chapel during the Celebrations. A short film on Carlo's life will be shown in the Conference Room. Everyone is welcome to this special time.

Sympathy

We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of:
Bobby Moran
Willie Shiels
Jim Moore
May they rest in peace

Anniversaries

Please pray for the repose of the souls of:
Jeanie Gallacher
Philomena Duffy
Margaret Lewis
Sheila Lewis
Johnny Lewis
Nancé Gallagher
Nellie Kerlin
John Feeney
May they rest in peace

Baptisms

We welcome as members of God's family:
Jackson James Burke
Órlaith Joan Nicholas
Matthew David Saunders
To book a Baptism contact the Parish Office 02871 262894

Readers for 29th /30th August

6.15pm Roisin Rice Cutter
7.30pm Niamh Kehoe
9.30am Kate Doherty
11.00am Helen Sweeney
12.30pm Megan Dallet
7.00pm Anna Begley

Collection

Weekly Collection: £5,877
Parish Development: £1,122
Thank you for your generosity

Thank you

Fr Farren acknowledges with thanks the following donations for:
Mary's Meals: £100 £50 £300 £20 £20
Smile Train: £50 £50 £20 £300 £60 £150 £40
Sight Savers: £300 £40 £20
Trócaire: £10

Sick Visitation

Fr Shaun Doherty will attend the sick and housebound in his care on Tuesday and Friday.

Sick Visitation

Fr Paul Farren will attend the sick and housebound in his care during the coming week:
Monday afternoon from 1.30pm:
Lisfannon Park, William Street,
Creggan Street, Fahan Street,
Cable Street, Lower Road, Abbey House, Little Diamond
Mulvey Park, Laburnum Terrace, Elmwood Terrace,
Westland Street, Westland Terrace, Gartan Square, Clarendon Manor, Northland Road

St Monica and St Augustine: On 28th August, we celebrate St Monica, whose faithful prayers for her son Augustine never ceased, even when he had wandered far from the Christian faith. Her patience, trust and perseverance are an encouragement to all who pray for their loved ones. On 29th August, we celebrate St Augustine, Bishop and Doctor of the Church. Through God's grace and his mother's prayers, Augustine experienced a profound conversion and became one of the Church's greatest teachers. Their lives remind us that no one is beyond God's mercy and that persistent prayer can bear beautiful fruit. May St Monica teach us to trust God patiently, and St Augustine inspire us always to seek the truth and rest our hearts in God.

Blessing of Bikers and Motorcycles will take place on Sunday 13th September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, Co Donegal, at 1.30pm. All are welcome to attend the brief service and blessing. Following the blessing all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13th September in St Patrick's Church, Dungiven, at 11.30am for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in past year.

Catholic Mothers Ireland – Family Day: Catholic Mothers Ireland will hold its Annual National Mass on Sunday, 6th September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry.

The day will begin with Mass at 2.00pm, celebrated by Bishop Donal McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents. This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more information and booking details, please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All are welcome.

Just five minutes from Derry, the IOSAS Centre and Celtic Prayer Garden is a special place of peace, community and connection. Enjoy freshly prepared homemade food in our warm and welcoming surroundings, then take time in our beautiful Celtic Prayer Garden, relax and experience its wonderful peace and serenity.

Come along, meet friends and discover somewhere truly different. Group bookings are very welcome, with ample parking and easy level access for visitors with mobility needs. Find us at F93 F104. For more information contact us at 00353 74 9384866.

Accord Derry – Marriage Preparation Workshops 2026 - Accord Derry is pleased to announce upcoming Marriage Preparation Workshops taking place in 2026. These courses are designed to support couples as they prepare for the Sacrament of Marriage.

The remaining available dates for 2026 are as follows:

- September: 25th–26th 2026
- November: 20th–21st 2026

All courses are now available for online booking at: www.accordni.com.

Please note that Accord Derry will not be facilitating Marriage Preparation Courses during October or December 2026. Couples are encouraged to book early to secure a place on their preferred date.

St Eugene's Cathedral is monitored by CCTV cameras and by two live streaming cameras. Live streaming can be viewed online at www.churchservices.tv, www.watchmcnmedia or the parish website. The Diocese of Derry Privacy Notice is displayed on the parish website and Cathedral notice board, or you may obtain a copy from the Parish Office.

Safeguarding Notice: If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of children within the Church please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +447596500793 or email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland emergency services: PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101 Social Services: Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (and ask for the Duty Social Worker), Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459, Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995. Republic of Ireland emergency services: Garda Síochána Buncrana: 00353 749 320 540 Letterkenny: 00353 749 167 100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency: 00353 749 102 23

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in Ordinary Time
23rd August 2026*

Priests: Fr Paul Farren, Fr Shaun Doherty